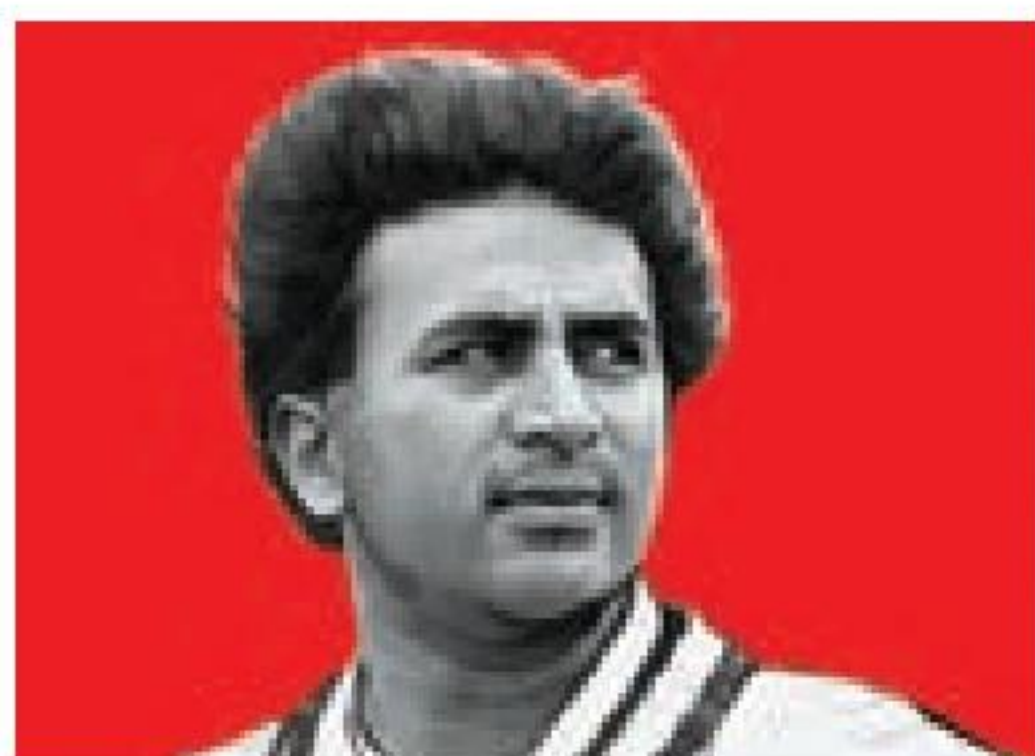




## ON THE WRITE LINE

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# OVER-RATE PENALTY CLAUSE IS VERY GOOD BUT PERHAPS NEEDS A TWEAK

The current rule, while effective, may need adjustments to **ensure fairness** during rain interruptions and tight finishes.

**P**lease allow me to begin this column with heartfelt thanks to our armed forces and all those whose bravery and vigilance at the borders, as well as inside the country, let us sleep peacefully at night. No praise can be too high for these women and men who put their lives on the line for India. Let us try to be worthy Indians for them, who are putting their lives and their families' lives at stake.

It is because of their swift retaliation that the IPL could restart with just a week's play being lost. **The BCCI engine room at the Cricket Centre in Mumbai swung into action and rescheduled the matches that were to be played on the days when the hostilities were ongoing, and a spanking new schedule was ready.** Again, like those who guard our country, no praise can be too high for those at the headquarters of Indian cricket who work tirelessly under the radar to keep the game up and running, not just in the IPL but throughout the cricketing season. Whenever one bumps into these guys, there's always a smile on their faces, even past the midnight hour after a late match finish. Just as the

commentators may be the faces of the tournament, the real stars are all those who sit in their chairs, focused on their monitors and sound systems to get you the broadcast pictures that you see on your TV and handheld devices. While the commentators could be ensconced in their beds a couple of hours or so after the end of the match, most of these unseen and unsung real heroes are still at the venue trying to derig and get ready for the next venue.

With monsoons anxious to start early, the BCCI had to take some hard calls about the selection of venues. So, Hyderabad and Chennai missed out while Bengaluru, falling in the same orbit, got a couple of games, out of which the first was rained off. The Chennai supporters are on tenterhooks about the future of their 'Thala' and would have been happy if one game was allotted to them. Anyway, that will give them hope that they will get to see him again next season.

The Mumbai Indians vs Gujarat Titans game was a thriller, with the current toppers of the league snatching a win off the last ball of the match. While the rains had halted the